DENTAL SEO | AI SEARCH | LOCAL GROWTH

Google Business Profile + Local SEO Growth Strategy

Prepared for

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Dental SEO | Google Business Profile Optimization | Local SEO Growth Strategy



October 2026 | Client strategy presentation

OVERVIEW

Engagement at a Glance

A 23-part growth strategy built on the practice's own data plus independent market research.

01 Executive Summary	09 Keyword Strategy	17 Local Link Building
02 SEO Baseline Analysis	10 Content Gap Analysis	18 Internal Linking Strategy
03 Technical SEO Audit	11 Service Page Strategy	19 AI Search Optimization
04 Google Business Profile Audit	12 Website Silo Structure	20 Conversion Optimization
05 GBP Optimization Strategy	13 Location Page Strategy	21 KPI Tracking Dashboard
06 Google Maps Ranking Strategy	14 E-E-A-T Analysis	22 90-Day Roadmap
07 Local Market Analysis	15 Review Growth Strategy	23 Priority Action Plan
08 Competitor Analysis	16 Citation Strategy	

HOW TO READ THIS DECK

CLIENT DATA

Baseline figures supplied by the practice: GBP rating and reviews, Semrush authority, traffic, keywords, links, AI visibility.

RESEARCHED

Verified in public sources in October 2026: skeltonbraces.com pages, AAO / ADA directories, competitor sites and listings.

RECOMMENDED

Consultant strategy, page plans and planning targets. Targets are ranges to manage toward, not guarantees.

Not estimated here: competitor review counts, local grid rankings and Core Web Vitals. These need live tools and are captured in Week 1 so no number in this deck is invented.

SECTION 01

Executive Summary

Skelton earns trust easily. The website and profile do not yet turn that trust into town-level search visibility.

5.0	126	187	85	9	28
GOOGLE RATING	GOOGLE REVIEWS	ORGANIC TRAFFIC	ORGANIC KEYWORDS	AUTHORITY SCORE	AI VISIBILITY
client data	client data	per month	client data	out of 100	10 AI mentions

Where Skelton stands

- Only orthodontic specialist office listed in Fort Payne in the directories reviewed
- Dr. Skelton: Fort Payne native, UAB-trained, 33-month orthodontic residency, 25 years in practice
- Strong brand trust: 5.0 stars across 126 reviews, patients treated from age 4 to adulthood
- Modern tech already in place: iTero scanner, in-house 3D-printed retainers, LightForce braces

What is holding growth back

- All 10 services sit on one URL (/services/), so no single page can win "Invisalign Fort Payne"
- No town pages for Rainsville, Collinsville or Scottsboro, while Carter Orthodontics runs two-city pages
- 187 visits and 85 keywords, Authority Score 9, AI visibility 28
- LightForce braces appear on the blog but not in the services menu

The growth play

- Build a service silo and a tiered location silo (about 16 new or upgraded pages)
- Turn the GBP into a service-led profile: services, posts, Q&A, treatment photos
- Raise review velocity and clean up citations (neighbouring practice at 2101 Grand Ave NW)
- Add an entity and schema layer so AI answers name Dr. Skelton and the practice

90-DAY PLANNING TARGETS Reviews 126 to 155+ | Organic traffic 187 to 250+ | Keywords 85 to 150 | AI visibility 28 to 40+ | Consultation requests tracked from day 1 (calls, forms, directions)

SECTION 02

SEO Baseline Analysis

A strong local reputation sits on a thin organic footprint: roughly 2 visits per ranking keyword.

SCORECARD

Authority Score 9 / 100

AI Visibility 28 / 100

Google Rating 5.0 / 5

187 organic visits / mo	**85** organic keywords	**583** backlinks
438 referring domains	**10** AI mentions	**126** Google reviews

Derived ratios: 187 visits / 85 keywords = 2.2 visits per keyword. 438 referring domains per 187 monthly visits = 2.3.

Finding	Current status	Problem	SEO impact	Priority
Organic traffic	187 visits / month	Mostly brand plus low-volume long tail	Few "Invisalign / braces + town" entries to grow from	HIGH
Keyword reach	85 keywords	Services cannot be targeted one by one	Ranking ceiling set by the single /services/ page	HIGH
Authority	Score 9 with 438 ref. domains	Link count out of step with authority: likely directory-heavy or low-quality	Needs a link-quality audit before any outreach	MEDIUM
AI search	Visibility 28, 10 mentions	Thin entity signals for the doctor, services and towns	Rarely named in AI answers for "orthodontist near me"	MEDIUM
Local / GBP	5.0 stars, 126 reviews	Strength is real but grid rankings are unmeasured	Cannot prove or protect Maps position without a baseline	MEDIUM

READ-ACROSS Authority Score moves slowly. The faster lever is relevance: dedicated service and town pages, a service-led GBP and entity clarity. Authority follows from local, relevant links, not volume.

SECTION 03

Technical SEO Audit

Found on the live site in October 2026: the foundations are sound, the architecture and a few details are costing leads.

Issue	Evidence observed	Impact	Recommendation	Priority
All services on one URL	10 services are anchors (#invisalign, #traditionalbraces) on /services/	No per-service relevance; weak GBP service links	Split into dedicated pages (see Sections 11 and 12)	HIGH
No town pages	Navigation and home page reference Fort Payne only	Misses "near Rainsville / Collinsville" searches	Tiered location pages (Section 13)	HIGH
Broken "Text Us" link	Mobile button uses an sms: link pointing to an email address	Lost mobile conversions	Use a real SMS number or remove	QUICK WIN
Generic metadata	/services/ description truncated and written as general "dental services"; og:description reads "Services -"	Weak search snippets, off-niche wording	Rewrite orthodontic-specific titles and descriptions	MEDIUM
Copy errors	"self-litigating systems" on the Technology section (should be self-ligating)	Credibility on a clinical page	Correct and proofread service copy	QUICK WIN
Early treatment routing	Home page "Early Orthodontic Evaluation" links to /about/	Wasted high-intent parent traffic	Dedicated Early Treatment page	MEDIUM
Vendor-managed site	WordPress build by DOCTOR Multimedia	Execution depends on vendor turnaround	Agree SLA and edit access in Week 1	MEDIUM
Not measured yet	Core Web Vitals, schema, XML sitemap, redirects, broken links	Unknown risk	PageSpeed, Search Console and a crawl in Week 1	MEDIUM

ALREADY WORKING Canonical tags set | Indexable (index, follow) | HTTPS | Title tag leads with "Orthodontist in Fort Payne, AL" | Click-to-call in header | Office tour, financial and new-patient pages exist

SECTION 04

Google Business Profile Audit

The reputation layer scores top marks. The relevance layer (services, posts, categories) is where rankings are left on the table.

A+ Rating and reviews 5.0 / 126	**A** Brand trust Pro photos, site linked	**B+** Photos Needs treatment images	**B-** Categories Secondary unverified	**C** Services Not itemised	**C** Posts Low frequency

GBP area	Current status	Issue	Recommendation	Expected impact
Name, address, phone	Match the website: 2105 Grand Ave NW, (256) 844-8221. Site hours Mon-Thu 8-5, Fri 8-2	Directory name variants ("Dr. Aimee Skelton, D.M.D., M.S., P.C."); a separate practice sits at 2101 Grand Ave NW	Lock one NAP format; confirm hours match; watch for merged listings	Cleaner trust signals, fewer mis-attributed reviews
Categories	Primary: Orthodontist	Secondary categories not verified	Audit competitor categories; add only accurate ones	Broader relevance
Services	Not itemised	No keyword-led service descriptions	List every service with a short description	Relevance for service searches
Posts and questions	Posting infrequent	Low freshness and engagement signals	Weekly posts; seed 8 patient questions	Engagement and freshness
Photos	Professional photos present	Few treatment and technology images	Add iTero, retainers, aligner and team images	Higher engagement and clicks
Reviews	5.0 from 126 reviews	Service and town keywords rarely mentioned	Prompt natural detail in requests	Relevance plus conversion

SECTION 05

GBP Optimization Strategy: Categories and Services

Turn the profile into a service menu: one entry per revenue service, each written for the patient and aimed at one query.

Service	Target keyword	Description focus	SEO value
Invisalign	Invisalign Fort Payne AL	Clear aligners for teens and adults, iTero preview	Highest-value lead
Traditional braces	Braces Fort Payne AL	Metal braces for kids and teens, colour choices	Core volume
Invisalign Teen	Invisalign for teens Fort Payne	Teen-friendly aligners, wear-time guidance	Parent intent
Adult orthodontics	Adult braces Fort Payne	Discreet options, bite and gum health	High-value adults
Early treatment	Child orthodontist Fort Payne	Evaluation by age 7, growth guidance	Parent and referral intent
LightForce braces	LightForce braces Fort Payne	Custom 3D-printed brackets (confirm offered)	Differentiator
iTero digital scan	Digital orthodontic scan	No impression goo, instant preview	Technology trust
Retainers	Orthodontic retainers Fort Payne	In-house 3D-printed retainers	Retention revenue
Surgical orthodontics	Orthognathic surgery orthodontist	Referral-based jaw correction plan	Complex-case authority

CATEGORY PLAN

CURRENT

Orthodontist (primary)

RECOMMENDED

Keep Orthodontist as primary. Add secondary categories only after a competitor category audit confirms they are accurate for the practice.

REASON

The primary category carries the most weight; wrong secondaries dilute relevance and risk suspension.

EXPECTED IMPACT

Wider "near me" relevance without losing core orthodontist ranking.

SECTION 05

GBP Optimization Strategy: Description, Photos, Posts, Q&A

A steady weekly rhythm matters more than a one-off clean-up.

OPTIMIZED BUSINESS DESCRIPTION

"Skelton Orthodontics is Fort Payne's hometown orthodontic practice, led by Dr. Aimee Skelton, a UAB-trained orthodontic specialist with 25 years of experience. We offer braces and Invisalign for children, teens and adults, early orthodontic evaluations and digital iTero scans with no messy impressions. Families from Fort Payne, Rainsville, Collinsville and across DeKalb County trust us for clear treatment plans and friendly, honest care. Request an appointment online or call (256) 844-8221."

Why it works: doctor credential, years of experience, services, town signals and a call to action, with no stuffing or unverifiable claims. About 520 characters (limit 750).

Photo plan (8-10 per month)

- Exterior, reception and treatment-room shots
- Dr. Skelton and team at work
- iTero scanning and in-house retainer printing
- Braces and aligner close-ups; community events
- Patient photos only with written consent

Post rhythm (weekly)

- Service: Invisalign, LightForce, early treatment
- Education: foods to avoid, retainer care
- Community: Senior Spotlight, Race to Embrace
- Doctor: credentials and milestones
- Every post links to the matching page

Q&A seed list: answer each on the profile and on the site

Search intent is informational and pricing-led. Each answer is two sentences and links to the matching page.

- What age should my child first see an orthodontist? (Early treatment page)
- Do you treat adults, and is Invisalign an option? (Invisalign page)
- How long does treatment usually take? (Invisalign and braces pages)
- Do you accept insurance, HSA or payment plans? (Financial Information)
- Where are you and when are you open? (Contact; hours Mon-Thu 8-5, Fri 8-2)

SECTION 06

Google Maps Ranking Strategy

Three ranking factors, one plan: Relevance is the biggest gap, Distance is Skelton's edge, Prominence is mostly built.

RELEVANCE — BIGGEST GAP

- Itemised GBP services with keywords
- Dedicated service pages the profile can link to
- Orthodontic secondary categories (audited)
- Reviews that mention the service and town

Today: category correct, services and content thin

DISTANCE — SKELTON'S EDGE

- Only orthodontic office listed in Fort Payne
- Town pages for Rainsville and Collinsville
- Drive-time and directions content
- Grid scans from each town centre

Today: strong at the core, unmeasured at the edges

PROMINENCE — MOSTLY BUILT

- 126 reviews at 5.0, keep velocity up
- Citation and NAP clean-up
- Local links: schools, Optimist Club, referrers
- Brand mentions and news features

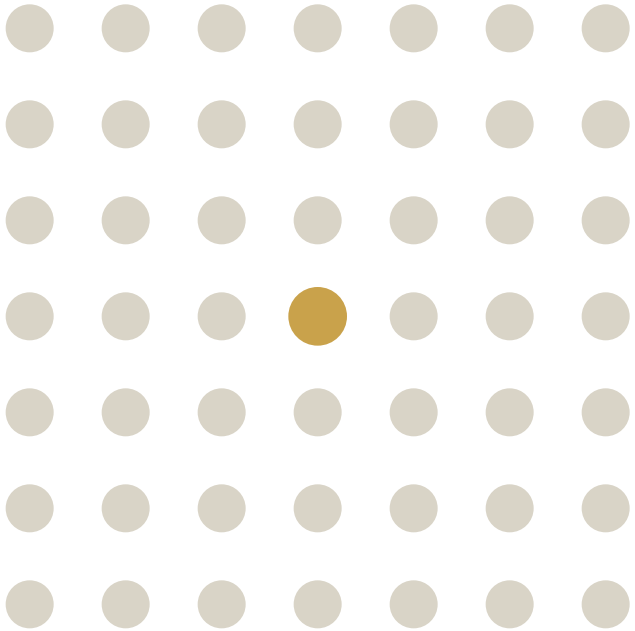
Today: Authority Score 9, links need a quality audit

Signal group	Action plan	Cadence
GBP signals	Services, categories, attributes, appointment link on the service page	Month 1
Review signals	Post-visit request with service-specific prompt	8-12 / month
Citation signals	Standardise name, address and phone across directories	Months 1-2
Content and authority	Service, town and FAQ pages plus local links	Months 2-3
Engagement signals	Weekly posts, photos, Q&A, call and direction tracking	Weekly

SECTION 06

Local Ranking Grid Tracking Framework

Measure rank from where patients actually search. Baselines are captured in Week 1, then re-scanned monthly.



Illustrative 7 x 7 scan geometry

Gold = practice location. Rank values populate after the Week 1 scan. No ranking figures are shown here because none were measured.

Keyword	Scan centre	Baseline	90-day target	Frequency
Orthodontist Fort Payne AL	Practice, Fort Payne	Week 1 scan	Top 3	Monthly
Braces Fort Payne AL	Practice, Fort Payne	Week 1 scan	Top 3	Monthly
Invisalign Fort Payne AL	Practice, Fort Payne	Week 1 scan	Top 3	Monthly
Invisalign dentist Fort Payne	Practice, Fort Payne	Week 1 scan	Top 5	Monthly
Orthodontist near me	Grid across DeKalb County	Week 1 scan	Top 5 inside 10 miles	Monthly
Orthodontist near Rainsville	Rainsville centre	Week 1 scan	Top 5	Monthly
Orthodontist near Collinsville	Collinsville centre	Week 1 scan	Top 5	Monthly
Teen braces / clear aligners	Practice, Fort Payne	Week 1 scan	Top 5	Monthly
Family orthodontist	Practice, Fort Payne	Week 1 scan	Top 3	Monthly

SECTION 07

Local Market Analysis

A small market with one specialist at its centre and a ring of orthodontists in the towns around it.

~15K	~72K	1	8
FORT PAYNE	DEKALB COUNTY	FORT PAYNE ORTHO	NEARBY ORTHOS

Residents: approximate 2020 Census. Ortho offices: specialist offices found in AAO locator and directory research, October 2026 (Fort Payne vs surrounding towns).

Market opportunity

- Parents of teens and a long tail of adults searching "orthodontist near me" in a town with one specialist
- Local identity is a real asset: Fort Payne native, Fort Payne High alum, 25 years of smiles

Challenges

- Patients on the north and west edges can choose Rainsville or Scottsboro offices
- Search volume for small-town terms is low, so every ranking must convert

Strategic direction

- Own Fort Payne outright, then claim Collinsville and Rainsville
- Treat Scottsboro and Albertville as Tier 2: contested, earn them with proof

COMPETITIVE GEOGRAPHY (approx. straight-line miles from Fort Payne)



Navy dots mark towns with an orthodontic specialist office. Coordinates approximate; confirm drive times in the Week 1 grid scan.

SECTION 08

Competitor Analysis: Who Patients Actually Compare

Independent research, not Semrush alone: five specialists whose offices sit in Skelton's target towns.

Competitor	Website	Locations	Services and positioning	Credentials and authority
Carter Orthodontics **Dr. Jared Carter**	carterbraces.com	Rainsville: 30 Bartlett Ave Scottsboro: 311 Parks Ave	Braces and Invisalign for children and adults. Home page leads with "Free Consultation. Same Day Start Available", financing and flexible appointments	UA orthodontic program; AAO, ADA and state dental association badges shown on site
Reynolds Orthodontics **Dr. R. Scott Reynolds**	Not confirmed (listings only)	Arab: 405 Cullman Rd Scottsboro: 114 E Willow St	Braces, overbite treatment, retainers and Invisalign trays per listing copy	UNC orthodontic program; UA dental school
Dr. Russell H. Lowrey	Not confirmed	Scottsboro: 327 Parks Ave Huntsville: 2319 Whitesburg Dr SE	Full-service orthodontics per AAO locator	UA orthodontic program
Lakeview Orthodontics **Dr. Don Schmidtke**	Not confirmed	Guntersville: 1939 Patterson St, Ste 103	Metal, ceramic and clear braces, Invisalign, surgical orthodontics; indirect bonding fabricated in its own lab	UAB dental; about 19 years of experience; reader-voted "Best of the Best" in a local newspaper
Dr. Byron T. Smith	Not confirmed	Albertville: 100 Andrew St, Ste F	Orthodontic specialist practice per AAO locator	UCSF orthodontic program; UA dental school

OUTER RING Gadsden specialists (Haynie, Wilborn, Walker) compete for south-county families. Two of them show American Board of Orthodontics certification on the AAO locator. Competitor review counts, ratings and ranking positions are pulled live in Week 1 rather than estimated.

SECTION 08

Competitor Analysis: Strengths, Weaknesses, Openings

Carter Orthodontics is the one rival that overlaps Skelton's own catchment. The rest are distance plays.

Competitor	Local SEO strength	Weakness	Opportunity for Skelton	Threat
Carter Orthodontics	Two-city presence; offer-led home page; separate Invisalign, braces-types and first-visit pages; reviews shown as Facebook proof	Dated site (COVID-19 banner link, no blog in navigation); reviews are screenshots, not live proof	Out-content them for Rainsville parents: town page, tech story (iTero, LightForce), fresh reviews, Fort Payne roots	HIGH
Reynolds Orthodontics	Established Arab and Scottsboro footprint	Few verifiable web assets found in research	Scottsboro page backed by local proof once patient data confirms demand	MEDIUM
Dr. Russell H. Lowrey	Scottsboro and Huntsville offices	Thin web presence found	Low threat to the Fort Payne core	LOW
Lakeview Orthodontics	Local award recognition; rich directory profile with insurance list; lab-made bonding story	Far from Fort Payne	Copy the playbook: earn "Best of" votes and press features in DeKalb County	LOW
Dr. Byron T. Smith	Specialist pedigree (UCSF)	Little web content found	Albertville is Tier 2: serve it with an area page, not a campaign	LOW

Why this matters for the plan

- Skelton's real fight is for Rainsville, Collinsville and the north county, where Carter already has a dedicated Rainsville office and a free-consultation hook.
- No competitor reviewed shows a deep service silo, a technology page or town-level content. The opening is wide if the work is done in the right order.

SECTION 08

Competitive Gap Analysis

Skelton leads on trust, technology and story. Carter leads on structure and offer. Structure is the cheaper gap to close.

Capability	Skelton	Carter
Google rating and reviews	5.0 from 126 (client data)	Pull live, Week 1
Dedicated Invisalign page	No (anchor on /services/)	Yes
Town or location pages	None found	Two office pages
Offer language on home page	None	"Free Consultation. Same Day Start"
Blog and education content	Yes (about 10 posts on page 1)	None in navigation
Technology story	iTero, 3D printing, LightForce	Not on home page
Doctor story	Fort Payne native, 25 years	"Small town guy, big education"
Financial information	Two pages	One page

"Offer" language is a decision for the practice. This deck never assumes a free consultation exists.

What competitors do better

- Separate pages per service and per office
- Clear offer in the first screen of the home page

Where Skelton has the advantage

- Review strength and 25-year local reputation
- Technology depth and an active content footprint

How to outperform

- Ship the service and town silo before anything else
- Add a truthful first-visit offer to every service CTA only if the practice offers one
- Use the 5.0 / 126 proof next to every call to action

SECTION 09

Keyword Strategy: Priority Map

Ten priority terms from the brief, each tied to one target page, one intent and one funnel stage.

Keyword	Search intent	Funnel stage	Business value	Target page
Orthodontist Fort Payne AL	Local, commercial	Decision	Very high	Home and Fort Payne hub page; GBP
Braces Fort Payne AL	Local service	Consideration	Very high	/braces/
Invisalign Fort Payne AL	Local service	Consideration	Very high	/invisalign/
Invisalign dentist Fort Payne	Local, mixed intent	Consideration	High	/invisalign/ with FAQ: orthodontist or dentist for Invisalign?
Orthodontist near me	Proximity	Decision	Very high	GBP, home page, town pages
Adult orthodontics	Service	Consideration	High	/braces/adults/ and /invisalign/adults/
Teen braces	Service, parent-led	Consideration	High	/braces/teens/
Clear aligners	Research	Awareness	Medium	/invisalign/ plus Invisalign vs braces guide
Orthodontic treatment	Informational	Awareness	Medium	/services/ hub
Family orthodontist	Local, commercial	Decision	High	Home page and About
Braces cost and HSA	Commercial research	Consideration	High	/braces-cost/ and the existing HSA post
Request orthodontic appointment	Transactional	Decision	Very high	/appointments/

SECTION 09

Keyword Strategy: The Full Query Universe

Local, commercial, informational and AI-style questions, grouped so each cluster has a home.

LOCAL

- Orthodontist Fort Payne AL
- Orthodontist near Rainsville
- Orthodontist near Collinsville
- Orthodontist DeKalb County AL
- Orthodontist near Scottsboro
- Orthodontist near Albertville

COMMERCIAL AND TRANSACTIONAL

- Best orthodontist in Fort Payne
- Invisalign vs braces cost
- Braces consultation Fort Payne
- Schedule orthodontic appointment
- Does HSA pay for braces
- Orthodontist accepting new patients

INFORMATIONAL

- Best age for braces
- How long do braces take
- How does Invisalign work
- Foods to avoid with braces
- Why wear a retainer
- Early orthodontic evaluation at age 7

AI AND VOICE QUESTIONS

- Who is the best orthodontist in Fort Payne, Alabama?
- Is there an orthodontist near me who does Invisalign?
- At what age should my child see an orthodontist?
- Hey Google, orthodontist open now near me
- How much do braces cost in Alabama?

HOW IT IS USED Local and commercial clusters feed the service and town pages. Informational clusters feed the blog and FAQ, each ending in a link to a money page. AI and voice questions become answer-first FAQ blocks of 40 to 60 words. Search volumes are validated in Semrush and Google Search Console in Week 1.

SECTION 10

Content Gap Analysis

The blog is active; the money pages and local pages that should capture its traffic do not exist yet.

Gap type	Content opportunity	Keyword	Business value	Priority
Service	Dedicated Invisalign page (today an anchor on /services/)	invisalign fort payne al	Highest-value lead	HIGH
Service	Braces, Teen Braces and Adult pages	braces fort payne al; teen braces	Core volume	HIGH
Service	LightForce braces page (blog post exists, no service page)	lightforce braces fort payne	Differentiator	HIGH
Service	Early Treatment page (home link points to /about/)	child orthodontist fort payne	Parent intent	HIGH
Location	Rainsville, Collinsville and DeKalb County pages	orthodontist near rainsville	Capture the edge towns	HIGH
Location	Scottsboro, Boaz, Albertville pages once proof exists	orthodontist near scottsboro	Tier 2 expansion	MEDIUM
Education	Invisalign vs braces, Invisalign cost, braces cost	invisalign vs braces	Decision-stage traffic	HIGH
Education	Treatment timeline and best age for braces	how long do braces take	Parent research	MEDIUM
Trust	Smile case gallery and patient stories (with consent)	braces before and after	Conversion proof	MEDIUM
Trust	One canonical doctor page (two Meet Dr. Skelton pages exist)	dr aimee skelton orthodontist	Entity clarity	MEDIUM

SECTION 11

Service Page Strategy

One page per revenue service: a unique URL, title tag, H1 and call to action, built on the same eight-part template.

Service page	Recommended URL	Title tag	H1	CTA
Invisalign	/invisalign/	Invisalign in Fort Payne, AL | Skelton Orthodontics	Invisalign in Fort Payne, AL	Request an Invisalign consultation
Traditional braces	/braces/	Braces in Fort Payne, AL | Skelton Orthodontics	Braces in Fort Payne, AL	Request an appointment
Teen braces	/braces/teens/	Teen Braces in Fort Payne, AL | Skelton Orthodontics	Braces for Teens in Fort Payne	Request an appointment
Adult orthodontics	/braces/adults/	Adult Braces and Orthodontics | Fort Payne, AL	Adult Orthodontics in Fort Payne	Request an adult consultation
Invisalign for teens	/invisalign/teens/	Invisalign Teen in Fort Payne, AL | Skelton Orthodontics	Invisalign for Teens in Fort Payne	Request an appointment
Early treatment	/early-treatment/	Child Orthodontist in Fort Payne, AL | Skelton Orthodontics	Early Orthodontic Evaluation	Schedule an evaluation
LightForce braces	/braces/lightforce/	LightForce Braces in Fort Payne, AL | Skelton Orthodontics	LightForce Braces in Fort Payne	Request an appointment
Retainers	/retainers/	Orthodontic Retainers in Fort Payne | Skelton Orthodontics	Retainers and Retention	Call the office
iTero scanner	/technology/itero-scanner/	iTero Digital Scanner | Skelton Orthodontics, Fort Payne	iTero Digital Scanning	See your smile preview
Orthognathic surgery	/orthognathic-surgery/	Surgical Orthodontics in Fort Payne, AL | Skelton Orthodontics	Orthognathic Surgery Planning	Request a consultation

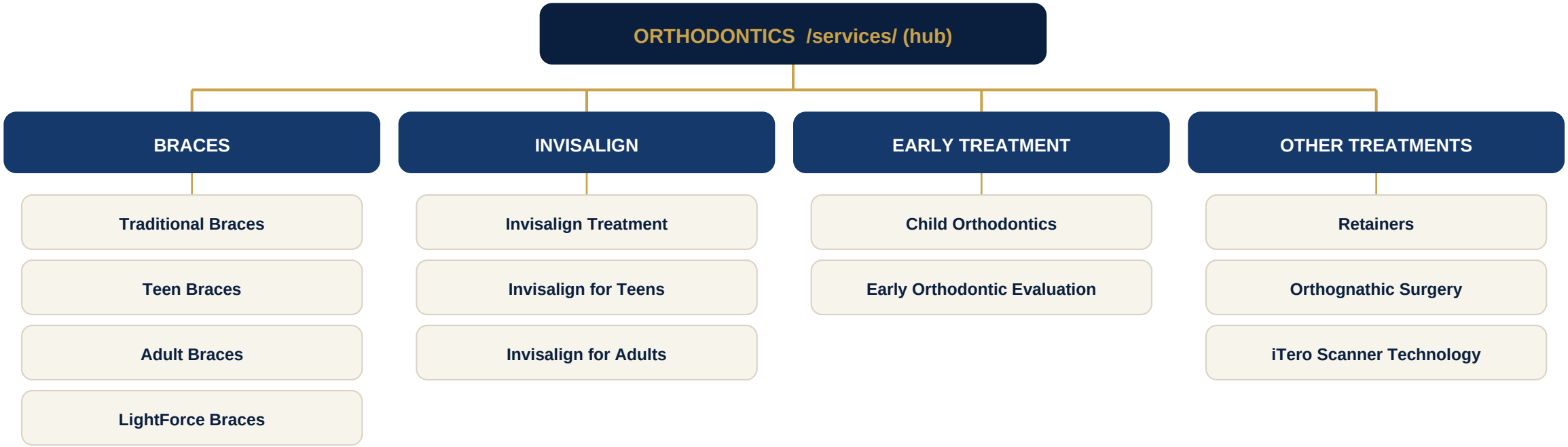
REQUIRED PAGE STRUCTURE

Introduction | Patient problem | Treatment | Benefits | Process | Care | FAQs | CTA

SECTION 12

Website Silo: Core Orthodontic Service Silo

Today one URL holds ten services. The proposal turns it into a 17-page silo with a clear parent and child for every treatment.



Silo rules

- Parents link only to their own children
- One primary keyword per page
- Pages built only where search demand exists

Page count

1 hub + 4 parents + 12 children = **17 pages**. Existing /services/ is rebuilt as the navigator, so no redirect is needed.

SEO priority

Build order: Invisalign, Braces, Teen, Adult, Early Treatment, LightForce, then the remaining pages.

SECTION 12

Website Silo: Location and Education Silos

Town pages capture "near me" demand; the education hub feeds them with decision-stage questions.

LOCATION SILO

Orthodontist in Fort Payne, AL

NEARBY SERVICE AREAS

Rainsville	Collinsville	DeKalb County
Scottsboro	Boaz	Albertville

Tier 1 (top row) first; Tier 2 (bottom row) when local proof exists

LOCAL ORTHODONTIC CONTENT

School calendars (exists), Senior Spotlight (exists), Race to Embrace and Optimist Club events, back-to-school braces guides, Fort Payne High athletics partnerships

EDUCATIONAL CONTENT SILO

Orthodontic Education hub

Braces information	Invisalign education	Patient FAQs
How braces work	Invisalign vs braces	Best age for braces
Braces cost	Invisalign cost	How long does treatment take
Braces treatment timeline	Invisalign treatment process	Orthodontic care questions

Fold in existing posts: When should my child see an orthodontist, Foods to avoid with braces, Does HSA pay for braces, Importance of wearing your retainer.

LINKING RULE Every education page ends with a link to its service page, and every town page links down to the service pages. Education supplies the questions, service pages hold the conversion, and town pages hold the local relevance.

SECTION 12

Website Silo Structure: Summary Blueprint

Four silos, one authority flow: Home to hub, hub to service, service to town, and education back up to service.

Silo	Purpose	Parent page	Child pages	Target keywords	Intent	Priority
Core services	Authority on revenue treatments	/services/	Braces (4), Invisalign (3), Early (2), Other (3)	braces fort payne; invisalign fort payne; adult orthodontics	Commercial	HIGH
Location	Local pack and "near me" capture	/orthodontist-fort-payne-al/	Rainsville, Collinsville, DeKalb County, Scottsboro, Boaz, Albertville	orthodontist near [town]	Local	HIGH
Education	Topical authority, decision research	/learn/	9 guides across braces, Invisalign, FAQs	invisalign vs braces; braces cost; best age for braces	Informational	MEDIUM
Trust and conversion	Proof and booking	/about/	Doctor, case gallery, reviews, new patient, financial, appointments	dr aimee skelton; orthodontist reviews	Trust	MEDIUM

Internal linking structure (authority flow)

- Homepage to Services hub and Fort Payne hub
- Services hub to four parent pages, parents to children
- Children to related services and to the Fort Payne page
- Location pages to the two or three services most searched there
- Education and FAQ pages to the matching service page

Silo creation rules applied

- Revenue services first: Invisalign and braces before retainers
- Separate pages only where search demand exists
- No thin town pages: each needs local proof and a unique outline
- Match each page to one patient intent
- Optimise for Google Search, Maps and AI answers together

SECTION 13

Location Page Strategy

Seven pages in three tiers: claim the nearby towns first, earn the contested ones with local proof.

Location	Target keyword	Recommended URL	H1	Required local signals	Tier
Fort Payne (hub)	Orthodontist Fort Payne AL	/orthodontist-fort-payne-al/	Orthodontist in Fort Payne, AL	Dr. Skelton story, Grand Ave directions, hours, reviews	TIER 1
Rainsville	Orthodontist near Rainsville AL	/orthodontist-near-rainsville-al/	Orthodontist Near Rainsville, AL	Route and drive time, Rainsville patient reviews	TIER 1
Collinsville	Orthodontist near Collinsville AL	/orthodontist-near-collinsville-al/	Orthodontist Near Collinsville, AL	Route and drive time, local school ties	TIER 1
DeKalb County	Orthodontist DeKalb County AL	/orthodontist-dekalb-county-al/	Orthodontist Serving DeKalb County	Umbrella page linking every town, map of towns served	TIER 1
Scottsboro	Orthodontist near Scottsboro AL	/orthodontist-near-scottsboro-al/	Orthodontist Near Scottsboro, AL	Proof of Scottsboro patients, drive time, reviews	TIER 2
Boaz and Albertville	Orthodontist near Albertville AL	/orthodontist-near-albertville-al/	Orthodontist Near Albertville, AL	Patient data by ZIP, drive time, local reviews	TIER 2
Northeast Alabama	Orthodontist Northeast Alabama	/orthodontist-northeast-alabama/	Orthodontist in Northeast Alabama	Regional umbrella; links to the tiers above	TIER 3

EVERY LOCATION PAGE MUST INCLUDE

- Local introduction
- Services available
- Nearby area relevance
- Directions
- FAQs
- Trust signals

GUARDRAIL Publish a town page only with real proof: patients by ZIP code from the practice system, drive time and local reviews. Thin copy-paste town pages dilute the whole silo.

SECTION 14

E-E-A-T Analysis: Dr. Aimee Skelton

Medical-adjacent searches reward demonstrable experience and credentials. Dr. Skelton's record is strong and under-presented.

EXPERIENCE — STRONG

HAVE

- 25 years in practice
- Fort Payne native and Fort Payne High alum
- Patients treated from age 4 to adulthood

MISSING

- Consented case gallery
- Patient counts and named stories

EXPERTISE — STRONG

HAVE

- BS Birmingham-Southern; DMD, UAB
- 33-month orthodontic residency
- AAO, SAO, ADA and Alabama dental memberships

MISSING

- ABO board status shown only if held (not shown on AAO locator)
- Person schema with credentials

AUTHORITATIVENESS — DEVELOPING

HAVE

- AAO, ADA, Sharecare directory listings
- Optimist Club Race to Embrace and Senior Spotlight

MISSING

- Local press and "Best of" features
- Links from schools, chamber, referrers

TRUSTWORTHINESS — STRONG

HAVE

- Consistent phone and address, HTTPS
- Privacy, terms, financial pages, patient portal, 5.0 stars

MISSING

- Fix broken Text Us link
- Reviewed-by line on clinical pages

FIX FIRST Two bio pages exist (/meet-dr-skelton/ and the blog post /meet-dr-aimee-skelton/). Consolidate to one canonical page with a credentials block and Person schema, then add a byline and "clinically reviewed by Dr. Skelton" to every treatment page. Expected impact: clearer entity for Google and AI answers, stronger trust at the decision point.

SECTION 15

Review Growth Strategy

Skelton is already at 5.0. The job now is velocity and detail: more reviews, mentioning the service and the town.

126	8-12	155+
REVIEWS NOW	NEW PER MONTH	BY DAY 90
5.0 average	planning range	target

Competitor gap: competitor review counts are pulled live in Week 1. Skelton's 126 reviews at 5.0 is the strength to protect, not a number to guess at.

Patient touchpoint	Timing	How
Braces removal or aligner finish	Same day, at the smile reveal	QR code at the front desk plus text link
Active treatment	Midpoint of aligner or braces	Text request, service-specific wording
New-patient exam	Within 48 hours	Parent text with the review link
Retainer delivery	At pickup	Front desk asks while the retainer is checked
Staff workflow	Weekly	One owner tracks count; replies within 2 business days

Review request templates

- **Positive:** "Thank you for trusting us with your smile! A quick Google review helps other Fort Payne families find us. [link]"
- **Service-specific:** "Congratulations on finishing [braces / Invisalign]! What did you like about the process and our team? [link]"
- **Follow-up:** "A friendly reminder: a short review takes about a minute and means a lot to our team. [link]"

Response strategy

- **Positive:** "Thank you, [Name]! We loved seeing your smile transformation. It is a joy to care for Fort Payne families. Dr. Skelton and team"
- **Negative:** "Thank you for telling us. We are sorry your visit fell short of what we aim for. Please call (256) 844-8221 so we can make it right." Never reveal patient details.

COMPLIANCE Do not offer gifts or discounts for reviews, and do not screen requests by expected rating. Both break Google policy. Encourage natural mentions of the treatment, the team and the town, never scripted keywords.

SECTION 16

Citation Strategy

Four directories already carry the practice. The work is consistency, plus the platforms that feed Invisalign and AI answers.

Platform	Status	Purpose	SEO value	Priority
AAO Find an Orthodontist	Found	Specialist trust; request-appointment form	High	HIGH
ADA Find a Dentist	Found	Dental authority; correct NAP	High	HIGH
Sharecare provider profile	Found	Health directory; lists Spanish language	Medium	MEDIUM
New Patients Inc practice finder	Found, name variant	Directory; unify the practice name	Medium	MEDIUM
Align Technology Find a Doctor	Verify	Invisalign lead source	High	QUICK WIN
Bing Places and Apple Business Connect	Verify	Feeds Bing, Siri and AI assistants	High	QUICK WIN
Healthgrades, Vitals, Yelp	Verify	Review and health directory coverage	Medium	MEDIUM
Fort Payne and DeKalb chambers	Verify	Local citation and link	High	HIGH
Alabama dental and orthodontic associations	Verify	Professional member links	Medium	MEDIUM

NAP consistency findings

- Phone (256) 844-8221 and 2105 Grand Ave NW match across the site and directories reviewed
- Name variants: "Skelton Orthodontics", "Dr. Aimee S. Skelton, DMD" and "Dr. Aimee Skelton, D.M.D., M.S., P.C."
- A separate practice (Skelton Family Dentistry) is listed at 2101 Grand Ave NW, next door. Guard against merged listings and mis-assigned reviews
- Fix: one canonical name and format, applied everywhere, then re-check quarterly

SECTION 17

Local Link Building Strategy

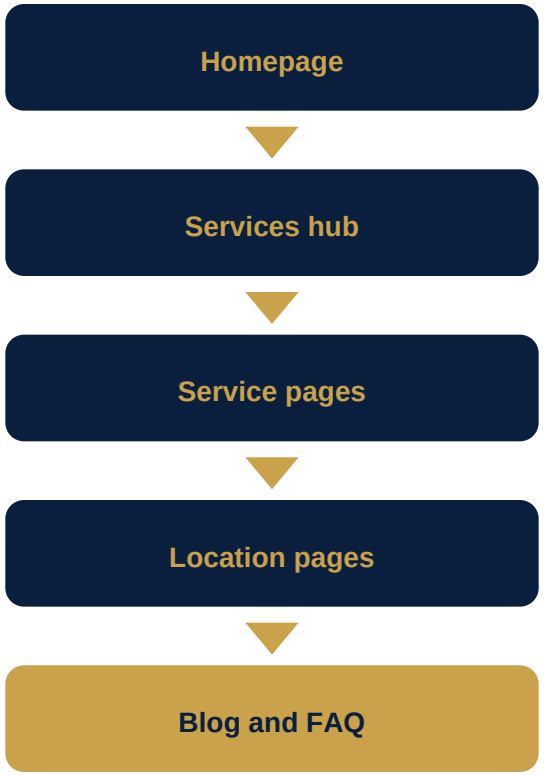
Quality over count: 438 referring domains at Authority Score 9 says the profile needs relevance, not more volume.

Opportunity	SEO value	Implementation method	Priority
Fort Payne High and city schools (Senior Spotlight already on site)	Local relevance, community authority	Sponsor or partner; ask for a link on school and booster pages	HIGH
Fort Payne Optimist Club (Race to Embrace)	Event page link, local brand mention	Sponsor recognition with a link to the practice	HIGH
DeKalb and Fort Payne chambers	Trusted local citation and link	Join or verify the listing and the member profile	HIGH
General dentists in Fort Payne (six practices in directories)	Referral relevance	Referral resource page; "what to expect" guides	MEDIUM
Local newspaper and radio	News mention, expert authority	Pitch "25 Years of Smiles" and back-to-school braces tips	MEDIUM
Pediatricians and school nurses	Trust and referrals	Share an early-evaluation resource sheet	MEDIUM
Own profile links (AAO, ADA, associations)	Profile links to the right pages	Update each profile to point to service and town pages	QUICK WIN
Existing link profile	Quality control	Audit the 438 referring domains for low-quality links	MEDIUM

SECTION 18

Internal Linking Strategy

Authority should flow from the homepage to money pages and back from every article. Today the menu is flat.



Today: flat menu; services are anchors on one page; blog-to-service links to be confirmed in the Week 1 crawl.

From	To	Anchor text recommendation
Fort Payne hub	Braces page	braces in Fort Payne, AL
Braces page	Invisalign page	compare with Invisalign clear aligners
Invisalign page	Invisalign for Teens	Invisalign Teen in Fort Payne
Rainsville page	Invisalign page	Invisalign near Rainsville
When Should My Child See an Orthodontist?	Early Treatment page	early orthodontic evaluation
Does HSA Pay for Braces?	Financial Information and Braces	payment options for braces
FAQ: How long does treatment take?	Invisalign and Braces pages	Invisalign treatment timeline
Importance of Wearing Your Retainer	Retainers page	orthodontic retainers

ANCHOR RULES Descriptive and varied, never "click here". Put the town name only in location links. Three to five contextual links per page. Service pages link sideways to two related services and across to the Fort Payne page; every blog and FAQ links up to one money page.

SECTION 19

AI Search Optimization Strategy

AI visibility of 28 with 10 mentions: assistants know the practice exists but have little structured proof to quote.

28
AI VISIBILITY
client data

10
AI MENTIONS
client data

Problems: two doctor bios, services merged on one page, town signals missing, no confirmed schema. **Platforms:** ChatGPT Search, Google AI Overviews, Gemini, voice assistants.

Entity	Today	Action
Business	Name variants across directories	One canonical name; sameAs links to GBP, Facebook, Instagram, AAO
Doctor	Two bio pages; LinkedIn profile	One bio page, Person schema with UAB and memberships
Services	All on one URL	One page per service with a plain-language definition
Location	Fort Payne only	Town pages with areaServed and consistent NAP

Schema plan

- Dentist / LocalBusiness for the practice
- Person for Dr. Skelton
- Service pages with plain-language definitions
- FAQPage and BreadcrumbList for structure
- No review markup of self-collected reviews: Google excludes it

Content for answer engines

- Answer-first FAQs of 40 to 60 words
- Clear expert explanations signed by Dr. Skelton
- Comparison pages: Invisalign vs braces, cost, timeline
- Voice-style questions: open now, near me, what age

Authority signals

- Reviews with treatment and town detail
- Complete Bing, Apple and Align profiles
- Local press and association mentions
- Quarterly AI visibility check against the 28 baseline

SECTION 20

Conversion Optimization Strategy

Traffic is only useful if it books. Most fixes here are small and fast.

Area	Observed today	Improvement	Expected impact	Priority
Website CTA	"Request Your Appointment" appears in header and each section	Service-specific CTA text on every page	More Invisalign and braces leads	HIGH
Mobile	Header phone link works; "Text Us" points to an email	Fix text link; add sticky call and appointment bar	More mobile calls and requests	QUICK WIN
Appointment form	/appointments/ form exists	Short form, clear confirmation, track submits	Fewer abandoned requests	HIGH
Trust at decision point	Four testimonials on home page	Add 5.0 / 126 badge beside every CTA	Higher form completion	MEDIUM
Price hesitation	Financial pages sit in the menu	Link payment and HSA answers next to CTAs	Fewer drop-offs	MEDIUM
GBP links	Website link connected	Point appointment link to /appointments/; add UTM tags	Measurable GBP leads	QUICK WIN
GBP calls and hours	Friday hours end at 2 pm	Keep hours and holiday hours current; track calls	Fewer missed calls	MEDIUM
Measurement	Conversions not confirmed	GA4 events: tel click, form submit, directions	Proof of ROI	HIGH

SECTION 21

KPI Tracking Dashboard

Baselines from the client data; targets are planning ranges, reviewed monthly against the live tools.

126 > 155+
GOOGLE REVIEWS
rating held at 5.0

187 > 250+
ORGANIC TRAFFIC
visits per month

85 > 150
ORGANIC KEYWORDS
ranking terms

28 > 40+
AI VISIBILITY
Semrush score

Metric	Baseline	Month 1	Month 2	Month 3	Source
Google rating	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.0	Google Business Profile
Google reviews	126	134	144	155+	Google Business Profile
GBP calls, directions, website clicks	Capture Week 1	Baseline set	+10%	+20%	GBP performance
Local pack rank, 4 core keywords	Week 1 grid scan	Tracked	Top 5	Top 3	Local grid tool
Organic traffic	187	195	220	250+	Semrush and Search Console
Organic keywords	85	100	125	150	Semrush
Authority Score	9	9	9	10	Semrush
Referring domains (quality audited)	438	Audit	+3 local	+6 local	Semrush
AI visibility / AI mentions	28 / 10	30 / 11	35 / 14	40+ / 18	Semrush AI tools
Consultation requests (forms and calls)	Capture Week 1	Baseline set	+10%	+20%	GA4 and call tracking
New-patient exams booked	From practice software	Baseline set	Track	Track	Cloud9 reports

SECTION 22

90-Day Implementation Roadmap

Foundation first, then growth, then authority. Each task shows its SEO area, owner and effort.

MONTH 1 — FOUNDATION

Baselines: grid scan, Search Console, GA4 events, competitor GBP pull
Tracking | Consultant | Easy

Fix Text Us link, "self-litigating" typo, /services/ metadata
Technical | Vendor | Easy

GBP services, description, categories audit, appointment link
GBP | Consultant + office | Easy

NAP and name-variant clean-up, check the 2101 Grand Ave listing
Citations | Consultant | Medium

Consolidate the two Meet Dr. Skelton pages
E-E-A-T | Vendor | Easy

MONTH 2 — GROWTH

Publish Invisalign, Braces, Teen, Adult and Early Treatment pages
Content | Vendor + consultant | Medium

LightForce and Technology pages
Content | Vendor | Easy

Tier 1 town pages: Fort Payne, Rainsville, Collinsville, DeKalb County
Local | Consultant | Medium

Launch review system: QR, text, templates
Reviews | Office | Easy

Four guides: Invisalign vs braces, costs, best age for braces
Content | Consultant | Medium

MONTH 3 — AUTHORITY

Citations: Align locator, Bing, Apple, health directories, chambers
Citations | Consultant | Easy

Local links: schools, Optimist Club, chamber, referring dentists
Links | Office + consultant | Medium

Schema and entity layer, answer-first FAQs
AI search | Vendor | Medium

Tier 2 town pages if proof exists
Local | Consultant | Medium

Day-90 review: grid rescan, KPI review, next 90-day plan
Reporting | Consultant | Easy

SECTION 23

Implementation Dependency Plan

What must finish first, what depends on what, and where the fastest return sits.

1 FOUNDATION

TASKS

Tracking and baselines, site fixes, GBP service menu, NAP clean-up

REASON

Gains cannot be proven or protected without a baseline, and GBP services need clean pages to link to.

DEPENDENCY

None. Starts on day 1; needs vendor edit access.

2 GROWTH

TASKS

Service pages, Tier 1 town pages, review engine, education guides

REASON

Relevance and conversion come before authority: links and mentions land on pages that exist.

DEPENDENCY

Foundation fixes done; vendor build capacity; new URLs for GBP.

3 AUTHORITY

TASKS

Citations, local links, schema and entity layer, Tier 2 pages

REASON

Authority compounds on pages that already convert and carry proof.

DEPENDENCY

Growth pages live; reviews, case photos and press assets ready.

FASTEST ROI 1) Fix the Text Us link. 2) Itemise GBP services and start weekly posts. 3) Ask for reviews at the smile reveal. 4) Publish the Invisalign page. These four need no new authority and start moving calls and requests within weeks.

SECTION 23

Priority Action Plan

Twelve actions sorted by impact and effort: start in the top-left, protect the build in the top-right.



#	Action	Impact	Difficulty	Priority
1	Fix Text Us link and "self-litigating" typo	Medium	Low	QUICK WIN
2	GBP services, description, appointment link	High	Low	QUICK WIN
3	Review requests at braces removal / aligner finish	High	Low	QUICK WIN
4	Weekly GBP posts and monthly photo cadence	Medium	Low	QUICK WIN
5	Invisalign, Braces, Teen, Adult pages	High	Medium	HIGH
6	Early Treatment and LightForce pages	High	Medium	HIGH
7	Fort Payne hub, Rainsville, Collinsville pages	High	Medium	HIGH
8	Citation and NAP clean-up incl. 2101 Grand Ave	High	Medium	HIGH
9	Invisalign vs braces and cost guides	Medium	Medium	HIGH
10	Local links: schools, Optimist Club, chamber	High	High	LONG-TERM
11	Entity, schema and answer-first content	Medium	Medium	LONG-TERM
12	Tier 2 pages: Scottsboro, Boaz, Albertville	Medium	High	LONG-TERM

NEXT STEPS

Let's make Skelton Orthodontics the obvious choice in Fort Payne.

1 Approve scope

Confirm website vendor access, GBP manager rights and Semrush / Search Console access.

2 Week 1 baselines

Grid scan, competitor GBP pull, GA4 events and call tracking.

3 Month 1 build

Site fixes, GBP service menu, NAP clean-up and the review system.

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Sources reviewed, October 2026: skeltonbraces.com (home, services, Meet Dr. Skelton, blog); AAO Find an Orthodontist; ADA Find a Dentist; Sharecare; New Patients Inc; carterbraces.com; Healthline FindCare; local newspaper feature on Lakeview Orthodontics. Client baseline data supplied by Skelton Orthodontics (Semrush, Google Business Profile).